How Did It All Start?

- It didn't start in 1947 — it actually started in **1846** when the British sold Kashmir to a Hindu ruler called the Maharaja through the **Treaty of Amritsar**
- Kashmir was mostly Muslim but had a Hindu ruler
- When partition happened, the Maharaja chose to join India even though geographically and religiously Kashmir was closer to Pakistan
- This caused the **1948 war**
- The UN stepped in and said there should be a ceasefire and a vote (plebiscite) — but the vote never happened

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Wars Fought

- **1948** — First Kashmir war
- **1965** — Second war between India and Pakistan
- **1971** — War (this one resulted in the creation of Bangladesh)
- **1999** — Kargil war

History of Kashmir

- Kashmir was originally Hindu and Buddhist
- Islam came in the **14th century** and became the majority religion
- Under Mughal rulers like Akbar and Zain-ul-Abidin, Kashmir was peaceful and religiously inclusive — considered a golden age
- After the Mughals, Afghans and Sikhs ruled — both were oppressive
- In **1846**, after the British defeated the Sikhs, they sold Kashmir to the Dogra Hindu ruler Gulab Singh
- Kashmir was actually made up of very different regions — Jammu, Ladakh, Baltistan, and the Kashmir Valley — all forced together under one ruler
- The Dogra rulers were very cruel to Muslim subjects — forced labor, heavy taxes, violence
- In **1931**, protests began — 22 protesters were shot dead, which sparked the freedom movement
- **Sheikh Abdullah** formed the National Conference in 1932 and started the "Quit Kashmir" movement in 1946

The Partition and Accession Problem

- In 1941, Muslims were **77%** of Kashmir's population, Hindus were **23%**
- Partition was extremely violent — 500,000 people killed, 15 million displaced
- The rule was that Muslim majority areas should go to Pakistan — but **Gurdaspur** was given to India on purpose to give India a land route into Kashmir

- This also gave India control over the Indus River — Pakistan's main water source — which later caused violations of the Indus Water Treaty
- India used double standards:
    - It took over **Junagadh and Hyderabad** by force (Hindu majority, Muslim ruler)
    - But accepted Kashmir's accession (Muslim majority, Hindu ruler)
- In October 1947, tribal people from NWFP crossed into Kashmir to help Kashmiris
- The Maharaja panicked and asked India for military help
- India said they would only help if Kashmir joined India — the Maharaja signed the **Instrument of Accession on October 26, 1947**
- India took the issue to the UN — ceasefire on **January 1, 1949** — Kashmir was split
- India's first PM Nehru promised a plebiscite (public vote) once things calmed down — he never kept that promise and neither did any government after him

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Article 370 and Political Developments

- **Article 370** gave Kashmir special autonomous status — meaning India could only make laws for Kashmir on defense, foreign affairs, and communications — everything else was Kashmir's own business
- Over time India slowly took away this autonomy
    - In 1963 they changed the title "Prime Minister of Kashmir" to "Chief Minister" and changed other titles too — reducing Kashmir's independent identity
- **Sheikh Abdullah** initially supported joining India but later wanted an independent Kashmir — he was dismissed and put in jail in 1953
- In **1987**, India rigged Kashmir's elections — this was a turning point that pushed Kashmiris towards armed resistance

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The Uprising and Human Rights Violations

- In **1989**, a massive protest movement called the **Intifada** started — people demanded "Azadi" (freedom/independence)
- India responded with tear gas, rubber bullets, and live ammunition against protesters
- **AFSPA** (Armed Forces Special Powers Act), **PSA** (Public Safety Act), and **TADA** gave Indian security forces the power to search, arrest, and even shoot people without any warrant or accountability — complete immunity
- **Rape was used as a weapon of war** — Human Rights Watch reported **882 women gang-raped in 1992 alone**
- Many women became **"half-widows"** — their husbands went missing and were never found, leaving women to head households alone under extreme trauma
- India deployed **700,000 military and paramilitary forces** for a population of only 12.6 million
- Since **2008**, and especially after the killing of **Burhan Wani in 2016**, Indian forces used **pellet guns** on protesters — blinding many people permanently
- Reports also mention use of chemical weapons
- India **bars foreign media and observers** from entering Kashmir

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August 5, 2019 — Removal of Special Status

- The BJP government **revoked Article 370** — this was seen as illegal and unconstitutional
- Kashmir was split into two union territories — **Jammu & Kashmir** and **Ladakh** — meaning they lost their statehood
- The entire valley was put under a long **curfew and communications blackout** — no internet, no phones
- **Article 35A** was also removed — this had stopped outsiders from buying land in Kashmir
- Removing it means non-Kashmiris can now buy land there — which is seen as a plan to change the Muslim majority into a minority over time

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Conclusion

- The conflict is still **unresolved** — no agreement, no vote, no peace
- India refuses to let any international body get involved
- The **UN needs to step in** to organize a fair plebiscite and stop human rights violations
- **Kashmiri leaders must be included** in any talks about their future — they cannot be left out of decisions about their own land